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Cyber Weekly Summary · 19 September 2026

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The main stories

- **Cisco announced an expansion of Splunk's AI agents for security operations.** Neither announcement calls it generally available, and the build-your-own-agent tool is planned for later this year.
- **Two Netskope venture investors distributed shares to their own backers.** ICONIQ funds passed on 5.5 million shares and Lightspeed about 3 million. Netskope's shares rose nearly 19% over the week, the Motley Fool reports.
- **MIND raised \$72 million for data loss prevention.** Crosspoint Capital Partners led the round. Total funding is now \$112 million.
- **Microsoft lists Purview's network-level data loss prevention as generally available.** The September release notes cover the route through Microsoft Entra Global Secure Access, Microsoft's own network service.
- **Two managed-detection deals.** Quorum Cyber signed an agreement to buy Ontinue. CyberMaxx acquired Avertium. Neither disclosed a price.
- **Exein raised \$270 million at a \$1.7 billion valuation.** The Italian company builds security software into connected devices.
- **The Center for Internet Security published a security benchmark for AI tool-call servers.** Version 1.0 has 55 recommendations and is free to download.
- **Proofpoint's reported talks to buy Varonis remain unconfirmed.** Varonis has filed nothing with the US securities regulator since 29 July.

Our view: Cisco is competing on its data and on controlling AI costs more than on agent autonomy. Zscaler's 9 September launch remains the clearest general-availability statement from an established vendor.

Security operations

Cisco expands Splunk's AI agents for security operations

- At its Splunk conference, Cisco said new agent capabilities expand the Splunk Agentic SOC Workforce. Splunk lists new skills for detection, investigation, response and governance.
- Neither company's announcement describes these agent skills as generally available. An Omdia analyst's table dates them to 15 September.
- **Available now, according to Cisco:** Cisco AI POD for Splunk, which brings Splunk's AI features to customers' own data centres; the Splunk AI Assistant; and monitoring of AI agents in Splunk Observability Cloud.

- **Planned:** Agent Launchpad, which lets customers build their own agents, is due later this year. A new activity-based pricing model is set for this autumn. No prices were published.
- Cisco says the Premier edition of Splunk Enterprise Security adds deeper agent autonomy, and the Essentials edition brings agent features to more teams.
- Cisco says a new cost tracker follows AI token spending, including employees' use of Claude Code, Codex and Cursor.
- Cisco says Splunk and Amazon Web Services have a multi-year agreement to develop products together. No value, term or delivery date was disclosed.
- The release names no customer. It names Accenture, bitsIO, Wipro and World Wide Technology as implementation partners.
- **Our view:** Cisco is selling its data and cost control more than agent autonomy. Omdia calls Cisco's network-data advantage "real but bounded", because it shrinks wherever customers run other vendors' equipment.
- **Watch:** an availability statement for the agent skills, and the delivery of Agent Launchpad.

Sources: *Cisco, Splunk, TechTarget, SiliconANGLE.*

Managed-detection providers combine

- **Quorum Cyber signed a definitive agreement to acquire Ontinue**, a managed-detection provider built around Microsoft's security tools. Terms were not disclosed, and no closing date was given.
- Quorum Cyber calls the planned combination a "Microsoft-first agentic SOC". The companies operate independently until the deal closes.
- **CyberMaxx acquired Avertium**, a security-services provider for mid-sized companies. The deal closed on 11 September and was announced on 16 September. Terms were not disclosed.
- Earlier, on 19 August, Cribl bought technology assets from Radiant Security's AI security-operations product.
- **Why it matters:** managed-detection providers are combining, and Quorum Cyber gives AI-assisted operations as part of its reason.

Sources: *PR Newswire, Avertium, Cribl.*

Other security-operations news

- **Zscaler:** Futurum's analysts say AI agents in security operations are becoming a standard feature. They cite a spending-intent survey score of 32 for Zscaler, down about three points. Futurum notes that Zscaler has published no named customers or pricing for the product.
- **Fortinet** promoted FortiSOAR 8.0 in a 14 September blog. Its release notes date the first release to 22 June, so this is not a new launch.
- **StrikeReady** received an investment from Wa'ed Ventures, Saudi Aramco's venture arm, according to one trade report. It gives total funding of \$29 million and no round size.

Sources: *The Futurum Group, Fortinet, FinTech Gate.*

Secure edge

Netskope: investors distribute shares; the price rises

- ICONIQ funds distributed **5.5 million** Netskope shares to their own investors on 16 September, for no payment. Lightspeed distributed about **3 million** on 10 September.
- These are transfers, not market sales. The one cash sale Lightspeed reported was 10,621 shares, worth about \$158,000.
- Stephens began coverage on 14 September with an Overweight rating and a **\$21** target. Many brokers already cover the stock.
- Shares rose nearly 19% over the week to \$17.49, the Motley Fool reports. It links the rise to a sector rally and the new coverage.
- **Our view:** distributions hand shares to holders who are free to sell. Two early investors doing this within a week can weigh on a recently listed share.

Sources: *SEC filing, ICONIQ, SEC filing, Lightspeed, MarketBeat, The Motley Fool.*

Netskope plans controls on AI-agent actions

- Netskope announced Agent Action Control on 15 September. The company says it sorts each action an AI agent attempts into one of nine categories before it runs.
- Security teams can then block, allow or flag the action, according to Netskope.
- **Availability:** Netskope says it will be available at the end of its current quarter. It is not available yet.
- Netskope also renamed its AI-security products "Netskope Skylight".

Source: *Netskope.*

Dell'Oro: add-ons such as data security are growing faster than the core

- Dell'Oro Group estimates the market for cloud-delivered network security reached **\$3.5 billion** in the second quarter, with growth above 20% for a fifth straight quarter.
- Data security and user-experience monitoring grew faster than the core gateway products, Dell'Oro says.
- Dell'Oro adds a limit: AI governance supports this growth, but "AI is not yet a standalone explanation". The free release gives no figures for individual vendors.

Source: *Dell'Oro Group.*

Other secure-edge news

- **Cloudflare** announced a setting that lets websites stay in search results while refusing AI training. Cloudflare says Apple, Google and Microsoft honour it or have committed to within a set time.
- **Share prices:** BankInfoSecurity calculates that Fortinet's shares have risen 102% since 7 April, and Zscaler's 40%. This is one journalist's calculation across 15 vendors.
- **Cato Networks:** South African provider iOCO added Cato's platform to its managed security services. No terms were disclosed.
- **Palo Alto Networks:** New Zealand's research and education network now offers its network-security products to universities. No value was disclosed.

Sources: *Cloudflare*, *BankInfoSecurity*, *CAJ News Africa*, *Reseller News NZ*.

Data security and insider risk

MIND raises \$72 million for data loss prevention

- MIND raised a **\$72 million** Series B led by Crosspoint Capital Partners. Existing investors YL Ventures and Paladin Capital Group joined. Total funding is **\$112 million**.
- Company sources told Calcalist the valuation is about **\$300 million**. MIND's own announcement gives no valuation.
- Chief executive Eran Barak co-founded Hexadite, which Microsoft acquired in 2017.
- **Why it matters:** investors are still funding a standalone data-loss-prevention vendor, while larger platforms add the same capability.

Sources: *MIND*, *Calcalist*.

Microsoft lists Purview network-level data loss prevention as generally available

- Microsoft's September release notes list general availability for Purview data loss prevention at the network level, through Microsoft Entra Global Secure Access.
- Microsoft says it protects text, files and AI interactions, and detects risky user activity through Insider Risk Management.
- The notes give a month, not a day. Microsoft issued no press release that we found.
- **Still in preview:** data loss prevention for non-Microsoft apps such as Box and Google Workspace.
- **Project Perception** remains in preview. Its product page describes consumption-based, pay-as-you-go pricing, with no figures. The page is undated, so we cannot say when this appeared.

Sources: *Microsoft Learn*, *Microsoft Security*.

Other data-security news

- **Varonis** launched Data Lifecycle Management, which finds and removes outdated and duplicate data. Varonis says it is available now.
- **Concentric AI** changed its sales leadership. It named Gary Olson Chief Revenue Officer on 9 September. Abstract Security named Jonathan Eller, whom it describes as Concentric AI's former global revenue leader, as its Chief Revenue Officer on 14 September.

Sources: *Varonis*, *Abstract Security*, *Concentric AI*.

Identity

Okta changes its board before its annual conference

- Okta appointed Helen Riley to its board on 18 September. She is Chief Financial Officer and Chief Operating Officer at X, Alphabet's research subsidiary.
- Emilie Choi stepped down from the board on 14 September. Okta gave no reason.
- Okta's Oktane conference runs **22–24 September**, with an investor summit on 23 September. Last week's summary gave the dates as 23–24 September.
- Okta's Auth0 unit opened early access to a permissions index for fine-grained authorization.

Sources: *Okta*, *Oktane*, *Auth0*.

Quest Software adds identity mapping for AI agents

- Quest announced five new capabilities for its security management platform on 16 September.
- One, Identity Insights, maps what human, machine and AI-agent accounts can access. It uses technology from Quest's June acquisition of Anetac.
- The announcement gives no availability date for Identity Insights.

Source: *Quest Software announcement*, via *CIO Influence*.

AI security and funding

A security benchmark for AI tool-call servers

- The Center for Internet Security released a benchmark for Model Context Protocol servers, the connectors AI agents use to call tools and data.
- It has **55 recommendations across 10 areas**, including logging and audit. It is free to download.
- We found no analyst-firm category for this market yet.
- **Why it matters:** vendors claiming to secure AI tool calls now have a published baseline that buyers and auditors can check them against.

Source: *Center for Internet Security.*

Funding at a glance

Company	What it does	Round	Lead investor
Exein	Security software built into connected devices	\$270 million , \$1.7 billion valuation	Headline
MIND	Data loss prevention	\$72 million Series B	Crosspoint Capital Partners
AIUC	Certifies enterprise AI agents	\$40 million Series A	Ribbit Capital
Comp AI	Compliance and security automation	\$34 million Series A	Roo Capital, Grand Ventures
Hackuity	Vulnerability management	\$19 million	Forgepoint Capital
Raindrop	Monitors deployed AI agents	Series A, size not disclosed; \$50 million raised in total	CRV
Eve Security	Runtime controls for AI agents	\$4.5 million seed	Run Ventures

- None of the rounds we could date this week went to an identity vendor.
- Raindrop and Eve Security both watch what AI agents do after deployment. Cisco says Splunk's monitoring of AI agents is now available in its cloud service. **Our view:** it overlaps with what these two start-ups sell.

Sources: *SecurityWeek*, *Raindrop*, *Dealroom News* and *MIND*. Each round is linked in the *full source notes*.

Acquisitions at a glance

Buyer	Target	Status	Price
Quorum Cyber	Ontinue	Definitive agreement signed; not closed	Undisclosed
CyberMaxx	Avertium	Completed 11 September	Undisclosed

Sources: *company announcements.*

Stories to watch

Proofpoint and Varonis

- Bloomberg's 2 September report of acquisition talks remains unconfirmed. The report itself said talks could fall apart or another bidder could emerge.
- Varonis has made no company filing with the US securities regulator since 29 July.
- Calcalist mentions a **\$6–7 billion** price without naming a source. Neither company has stated a price.
- **Watch for:** a company announcement, a regulatory filing or a denial.

Sources: *Yahoo Finance*, *SEC filing index*, *Calcalist*.

Accenture's security acquisitions

- Accenture has published no completion notice for Dragos, runZero or NetRise. It expected the roughly **\$4.175 billion** deals to close in August or September.
- runZero's site still describes the deal in the future tense.

Sources: *Accenture*, *runZero*.

Cyberhaven's Claude Enterprise connector

- Cyberhaven's July announcement promised the connector for August. Its newsroom still shows no launch announcement. Its latest press release is dated 19 August.

Source: *Cyberhaven*.

Industry groups

- The AI Proving Grounds Consortium's site shows **seven** member logos. Dreadnode's logo was added on 8 September without an announcement. Last week's summary counted six.
- The Agentic SOC Alliance page still shows 15 member logos.

Sources: *AI Proving Grounds Consortium*, *ExtraHop*.

Coming events

- **Okta Oktane, 22–24 September:** watch for product and availability announcements.
- **AI Proving Grounds Consortium, 24 September:** virtual event on governing AI, with a Gartner keynote.
- **Microsoft Ignite, 17–20 November.**

Sources: *Okta*, *AI Proving Grounds Consortium*, *Microsoft Ignite*.

Our predictions

- This week changes none of our seven assessments from 12 September. MIND's funding and Cisco's expansion are evidence we will weigh at the next prediction update.

Sources

The [full source notes](#) link each reported development to company announcements, regulatory filings or named publications.